

LoGST Architecture — Coordinate-Invariant Local-Global Spatial Transformer

Task: Predict gene expression at every tissue spot from H&E patch features.

Input (per slide):

- $\mathbf{F} \in \mathbb{R}^{N \times 1536}$ — frozen UNI+CONCH patch embeddings
- $\mathbf{C} \in \mathbb{R}^{N \times 2}$ — spot pixel coordinates

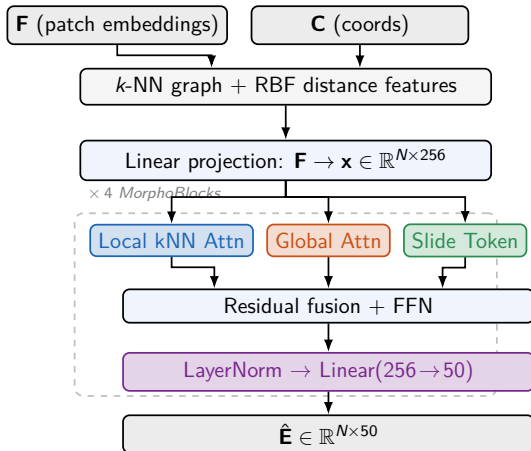
Output: $\hat{\mathbf{E}} \in \mathbb{R}^{N \times 50}$ — predicted log-normalised expression

Coordinate invariance:

Coordinates enter *only* via pairwise distances (RBF-encoded).

⇒ invariant to translation, rotation & reflection.

Single forward pass — 4.88 M params



Results — Intra-Cohort (Table 1) & Cross-Organ LOOO (Table 2)

Table 1: Intra-cohort PCC per organ (HEST-1k)

All methods: frozen UNI+CONCH, 50 genes, 3 seeds

Cohort	ST-Net	Hist2ST	HyperST	BLEEP	STEM	LoGST
IDC (Breast)	0.551	0.309	0.567	0.519	0.439	0.581
COAD (Colorectal)	0.242	0.295	0.285	0.314	0.177	0.318
CCRCC (Kidney)	0.163	0.184	0.256	0.175	0.123	0.252
LUNG	0.518	0.470	0.587	0.562	0.423	0.589
PAAD (Pancreas)	0.359	0.247	0.404	0.419	0.233	0.437
PRAD (Prostate)	0.294	0.333	0.384	0.348	0.207	0.410
SKCM (Skin)	0.665	0.522	0.653	0.645	0.491	0.707
Average	0.399	0.337	0.448	0.426	0.299	0.470

+6.6% relative PCC gain over best baseline (HyperST)

Table 2: Cross-organ LOOO PCC per organ

Trained on 6 organs, tested on held-out organ

Cohort	ST-Net	Hist2ST	HyperST	BLEEP	LoGST
IDC (Breast)	0.198	0.458	0.465	0.529	0.520
COAD (Colorectal)	0.420	0.670	0.669	0.662	0.729
CCRCC (Kidney)	0.068	0.055	0.106	0.095	0.109
LUNG	0.493	0.378	0.657	0.624	0.675
PAAD (Pancreas)	0.459	0.399	0.463	0.537	0.548
PRAD (Prostate)	0.079	0.098	0.114	0.118	0.118
SKCM (Skin)	0.520	0.736	0.725	0.748	0.728
Average	0.319	0.399	0.457	0.473	0.490

LoGST leads on 5/7 organs under organ-shift transfer

Results — Ablation (Table 7) & Coordinate Invariance (Table 8)

Table 7: Factorial Context Ablation (Intra-cohort)

L=Local attention, G=Global attention, S=Slide token

Config	L	G	S	SKCM	LUNG	Avg
C000 (MLP only)				0.639	0.577	0.608
C001			•	0.633	0.578	0.605
C010		•		0.641	0.577	0.609
C011		•	•	0.639	0.583	0.611
C100	•			0.693	0.587	0.640
C101	•		•	0.695	0.585	0.640
C110	•	•		0.693	0.584	0.638
C111 (LoGST)	•	•	•	0.696	0.589	0.643

Local attention (+0.032 avg) is the dominant single contributor.

All three components together achieve the best performance.

Table 8: Numerical Coordinate-Invariance Check

Randomly initialised model, 257-spot synthetic slide.

Max. absolute output difference after coordinate transformation.

Transformation	Max. $ \Delta $
Translation	5.97×10^{-5}
Rotation	1.97×10^{-5}
Reflection	0
Spot permutation	5.96×10^{-7}

Differences are numerical noise ($< 10^{-4}$), confirming predictions are invariant to how the tissue slide is oriented or positioned.

Why it matters: Two labs imaging the same tissue with different coordinate origins or rotated